



Cihat Eray Balat

Video Producer · Motion Designer · Student of Radio, Television and Cinema

Date of birth 1 October 2005

Nationality Turkish

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Driving licence Category B

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ABOUT ME

I write, direct, film, edit, grade and score short films, documentaries and brand content. In 2026 my short film *Boomerang* received an **Honorable Mention from Robert F. Kennedy Human Rights** in their Student Video Contest — recognition I value because it came from a human rights organisation rather than a purely cinematic one.

Alongside my BA in Radio, Television and Cinema I run a small independent studio serving clients in the EU and the United States in English, and I produce educational video, unpaid, for a volunteer-run philosophy channel aimed at students who cannot afford private exam preparation. In 2025 I took part in DiscoverEU as a participant and ambassador.

I work daily with AI production tools, which gives me a practical understanding of how synthetic images, voices and video are made — and therefore of how manipulated content can be recognised. I believe this matters for journalism today, and for the disinformation and hate speech that minority and vulnerable communities face online. I am looking for a placement where visual storytelling serves a community rather than a client.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Founder and Creative Producer

Citrine Studio — independent video studio, remote (EU and US clients)

April 2025 - present

- Write, direct, film, edit, colour-grade and score documentaries, short films, music videos and brand content, from concept to final delivery.
- Produced a 17-minute documentary including an original filmed interview with its central subject; released with subtitles in 13 languages, translated and timed in-house.
- Delivered a full brand campaign in 72 hours: three films, six product films and an original score.
- Produce multilingual versions of video using voice-over localisation and lip synchronisation, so one film can reach several language markets.
- Handle all client communication, quoting, scheduling and delivery in English.

AI Video Producer and Motion Designer

Balp Dijital — advertising agency, Kayseri, Türkiye

June 2024 - February 2026

- Designed and maintained the motion identity of a home textile brand for over a year; the brand's organic social following grew from 40,000 to over 160,000.
- Produced high-volume social motion design for retail and consumer clients at agency turnaround times.
- Introduced AI generation into the agency's production pipeline, significantly reducing production time on campaign assets.

Ambassador

Suno — AI music platform, remote (contract)

June 2025 - July 2025

- Selected as a platform ambassador to produce daily AI-music visual content, combining footage I shoot myself with platform-generated tracks.
- Compose original scores for my own films and for other independent creators; over 5,500 tracks produced to date.

Social Media Marketing and Event Coordinator

Oniki — AI-powered B2B event technology, Istanbul, Türkiye (internship)

January 2024 - December 2024

- Coordinated on-site field operations at large trade fairs and exhibitions in major cities across Türkiye, as part of the event delivery team.
- Produced social media content for a B2B matchmaking platform; worked directly with international exhibitors and participants.

AWARDS AND FESTIVALS

Honorable Mention

Boomerang — Student Video Contest, Robert F. Kennedy Human Rights, 2026

Official Selection

Boomerang — international film festival, 2026

Festival submissions

Boomerang (10) · *Run or Run* (7) · *Die Post* (3)
— written and directed by me

WRITING EXPERIENCE

- **Screenwriting** — wrote the screenplays for *Boomerang*, *Run or Run* and *Die Post*.
- **Documentary** — wrote the interview questions and narrative structure for a 17-minute documentary.
- **Subtitling and translation** — wrote, translated and timed English subtitles; delivered subtitle versions in 13 languages, under strict character and timing limits.
- **Content writing** — wrote and published regularly for over a year across three social platforms, each with a different tone and format.
- **Academic writing** — essays and research assignments in media theory, communication studies and film analysis.

I have not yet written for a news outlet or online publication. This is precisely the area I would like to develop.

DIGITAL SKILLS

VIDEO AND EDITING

Adobe Premiere Pro · After Effects · filming and camera operation · editing · colour grading · subtitling and subtitle timing

MOTION AND DESIGN

Motion graphics · titles and lower thirds · Adobe Photoshop · brand visual identity · social formats (9:16, 1:1, 4:5)

AI PRODUCTION

Image, video and music generation · AI voice-over and multilingual localisation · lip synchronisation · working understanding of how synthetic media is produced and identified

AUDIO

Original score composition · sound design · Adobe Audition · podcast-level recording and mixing

SOCIAL MEDIA

Owner and Social Media Manager

Mavi Girişimci — self-employed content project

May 2022 – July 2023

- Founded and ran an independent content channel on self-development, entrepreneurship and business, publishing on Instagram, YouTube and TikTok.
- Full cycle alone: research, writing scripts and text, filming, editing, publishing and community interaction. My first sustained experience of writing regularly for an audience.

VOLUNTEERING

Volunteer Video Producer

Felsefehanem — independent educational channel, Türkiye

2025 – present • unpaid

- Produce educational philosophy videos, without payment, for a small channel aimed at students preparing for the national university entrance examination.
- Responsible for editing, motion graphics and the channel's visual identity.
- My motivation is access: private exam preparation in Türkiye is expensive, and good material should not depend on being able to pay for it.

Participant and Ambassador

DiscoverEU — European Commission / Erasmus+

2025

- Selected for a DiscoverEU rail pass and travelled independently across Europe.
- As an ambassador, publicly shared my experience to encourage other young people in Türkiye to apply; my story was featured on the official European Youth channel.

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

BA, Radio, Television and Cinema

Erciyes University, Faculty of Communication — Kayseri, Türkiye

September 2024 – expected June 2028 • ongoing, third year

- Film directing, screenwriting, film and video production, cinematography, editing, media theory and communication studies.
- Coursework includes academic writing, media analysis and research methods in communication.
- Wrote and directed short films as part of my studies, three of which were submitted to international festivals.

21st Century Competencies Training Programme

Yetkin Gençler (YetGen) — 124 hours, advanced level, 14-week programme

September – December 2022 • certificate issued February 2023

- Media and information literacy, digital literacy, financial literacy, active citizenship, leadership, social innovation and sustainability, career planning, presentation technique, teamwork.
- Included the GirişGen ideathon: developing a solution to a global problem framed by the UN Sustainable Development Goals.
- Verifiable at verified.certifier.com/en/verify/31153190739918

Additional training

2020 – 2024

- Cyber security and ethical hacking course — information security fundamentals, common attack methods and defensive practice. Relevant to digital safety when working with vulnerable communities.
- Mobile application development with Kotlin.
- Secondary education completed through the Open Education High School, Türkiye.
- Self-taught in video editing, motion design, colour grading, sound design, music composition and AI production tools.

Organic content creation and strategy • management across Instagram, YouTube and TikTok • channel growth • community interaction

WEB AND GENERAL

Built and maintain my own portfolio site, source published openly on GitHub • Notion • Slack • Google Drive • independent remote working

LANGUAGES

	Lis	Read	Spk prod	Spk int	Writ
Turkish	Mother tongue				
English	B2	B2	B1	B1	B1
German	A2	A2	A1	A1	A1
Arabic	A2	A2	A1	A1	A1

I work with international clients in English daily, in writing and speech.

LINKS

Portfolio eraybalat.com
Instagram instagram.com/documenteray
GitHub github.com/eraybalatt
LinkedIn linkedin.com/in/eraybalat

INTERESTS

Documentary and short film • music production and composition • traditional leather craft, hand-tooled Anatolian and Seljuk motifs • tennis, running and swimming • travel, and working out how an unfamiliar place functions.